# Team Retrospective Kit

A HuddleOnCollabAlliance digital template pack

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# Team Retrospective Kit: Facilitator Guide

A retrospective is a regular, structured conversation where a team looks at how it worked and chooses a few improvements. This kit includes five formats you can run in 45 to 90 minutes.

## Ground rules

Focus on process and results, not on individuals.

Everyone speaks; use silent writing first so quieter voices count.

Leave with no more than three actions, each with an owner and date.

## Room setup (in person or remote)

In person: wall space, sticky notes in three colors, markers, dot stickers.

Remote: a shared whiteboard with one column per prompt and a visible timer.

# Format 1: Start, Stop, Continue (45 min)

The simplest format. Good for new teams.

## Steps

1. Set the stage (5 min): restate the period being discussed.
2. Silent writing (10 min): each person writes notes for Start, Stop and Continue.
3. Group and discuss (15 min): cluster similar notes.
4. Vote (5 min): three dots per person.
5. Choose actions (10 min): top voted items become actions.

**Start doing**

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**Stop doing**

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**Continue doing**

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# Format 2: Sailboat (60 min)

A visual metaphor that makes risks and drivers easy to talk about.

## Draw the scene

Wind: what pushes us forward.

Anchor: what slows us down.

Rocks: risks ahead.

Island: the goal we are sailing toward.

## Steps

Write notes for each element (10 min), share (20 min), vote (5 min), turn the top items into actions (15 min).

### Wind

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### Anchors

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### Rocks

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### Chosen actions

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# Format 3: 4Ls (60 min)

Liked, Learned, Lacked, Longed for. Balanced between positives and gaps.

## Steps

Give each prompt four minutes of silent writing.
Read notes aloud one prompt at a time.
Look for patterns that repeat across prompts.
Pick one action for Lacked and one for Longed for.

**Liked**

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**Learned**

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**Lacked**

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**Longed for**

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# Format 4: Mad, Sad, Glad (60 min)

Surfaces how the work felt as well as what happened.

## Steps

Write notes in each category (10 min).
Share Glad first to build momentum, then Sad and Mad (20 min).
Discuss root causes for the biggest clusters (15 min).
Agree on actions (15 min).

**Mad**

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**Sad**

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**Glad**

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# Format 5: Timeline (90 min)

Best after a long project or quarter.

## Steps

Draw a line across the wall from beginning to end.
Each person adds events with high and low moments (15 min).
Walk the timeline together and ask what changed (25 min).
Find turning points and extract lessons (25 min).
Pick actions for the next period (25 min).

**Key events**

**Turning points**

**Lessons**

**Actions**

# Action tracker

Record the actions you agreed on and go over them at the next retrospective.

## Rules for good actions

Specific: begins with a verb.
Owned: one named person.
Dated: a due date within the next iteration.
Visible: added to the team backlog.

**Action 1 (owner / due date)**

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**Action 2 (owner / due date)**

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**Action 3 (owner / due date)**

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